

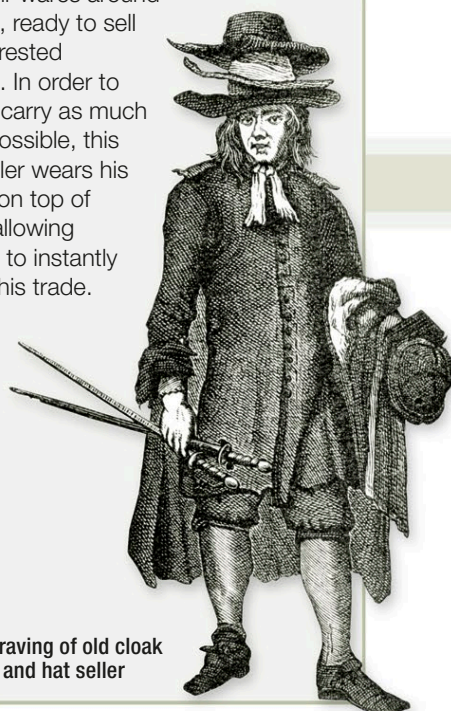
1685–1720

TOWARDS THE SUIT

The silhouette of the coat became increasingly exaggerated, worn tight on the waist and flaring to full pleated skirts below. Decorative braiding was applied along the centre front closure, pockets, and cuffs. Sleeves became longer and tighter, but cuffs remained large. The waistcoat, still fitted close to the body, was now worn shorter than the coat. While the waistcoat front was richly decorated, the back was frequently made of plainer fabric as it was rarely seen. Breeches were worn narrower and closer to the leg, fastening just above or below the knee. They were made from the same material as the coat or from a plain black fabric – the forerunner of the suit. From the 1690s large ornamental buttons became popular on pockets with decorative flaps and on cuffs as well as forming the front fastening. These buttons could be made from decorative metal or from the same fabric as the coat and finished with embroidery.

CLOTHES SELLER

Expensive garments were made to measure, but there were many ways of buying cheaper clothing. Basic garments such as shirts and breeches could be bought in towns and cities from large clothing warehouses, and second-hand garments could be purchased in markets or from clothes sellers. These traders carried their wares around the streets, ready to sell to any interested customers. In order to be able to carry as much stock as possible, this clothes seller wears his hats piled on top of his head, allowing customers to instantly recognize his trade.



Engraving of old cloak and hat seller

Finishing touch This long, flared coat is worn with shoes with a fashionably high tongue. The tongue could be folded over to reveal a coloured lining and was often cut into a scallop shape around the edge.



High peaked wig

Decorated pocket flaps

Buttons on centre front fastening

Square-toed shoes with high tongue and matching heel

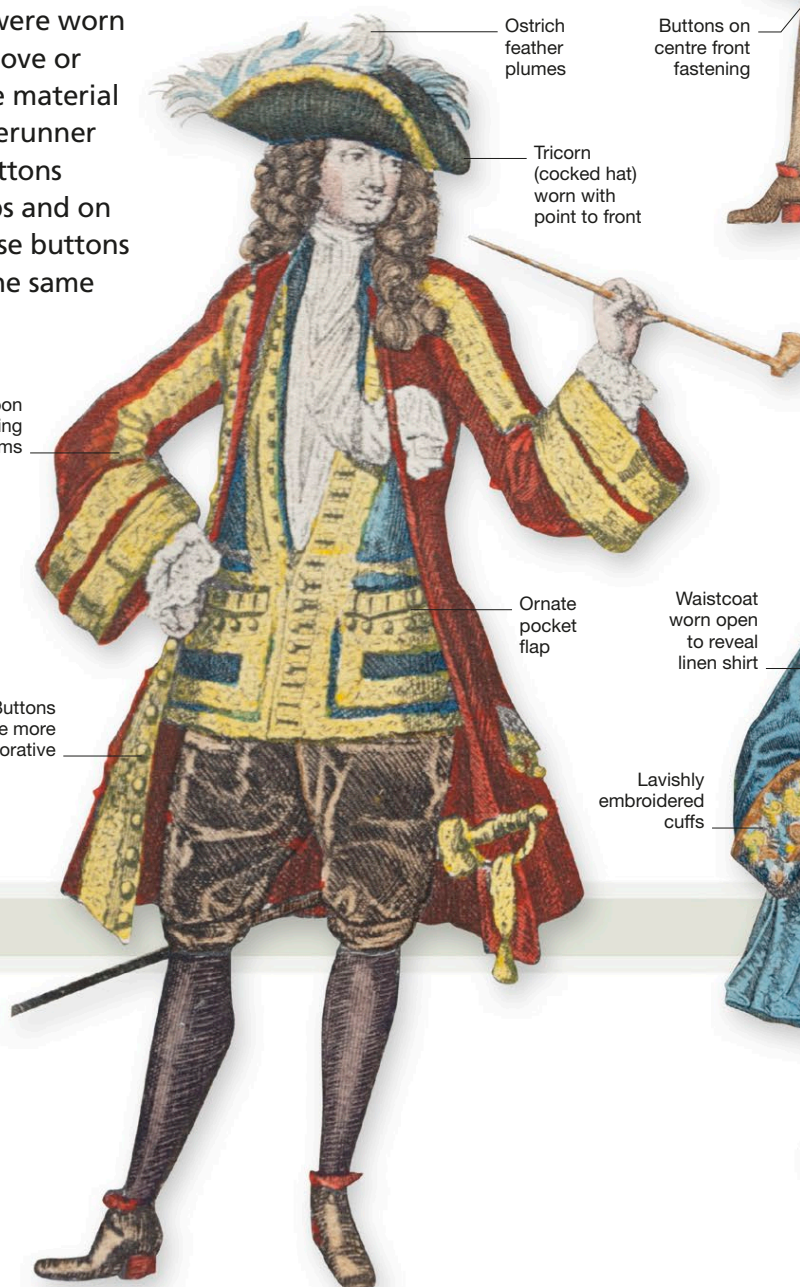
Gold galloon braiding on arms

Buttons are more decorative

Ornate pocket flap

Waistcoat worn open to reveal linen shirt

Lavishly embroidered cuffs



Cocked hat The wide-brimmed felt hat was now worn with the brim turned up in three folds to create a style known as a tricorn. Rich gold galloon braiding was added as a decorative trim on the turned-up edges.

Laced breeches Gathered into a waistband, breeches could be adjusted by laces at the centre back. They were held up with a tie around the waist, often a decorative sash.